# Relative Clauses

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# Intended Learning Outcomes

- ✓ Identify relative pronouns
- ✓ Use them correctly in sentences
- ✓ Understand relative clauses
- ✓ Use relative clauses in speaking and writing

# Warm-up Activity

Look at these sentences:

1. The student is very intelligent.
2. The student won the competition.

👉 How can we connect them?

# What Are Relative Pronouns?

Relative pronouns connect two sentences and give more information about a noun.

They help us avoid repetition and improve clarity.

Example:

- The student who won the competition is intelligent.

# Common Relative Pronouns

- Who – for people (Subject)
- Whom - for people (Object)
- Which – for things
- That – for people and things
- Whose – possession
- Where – places
- When – time
- Why- reason

| Pronoun | Usage | Example |
|---|---|---|
| WHO | People (subject) | The teacher who teaches English is very nice. |
| WHOM | People (object) | The man whom I met yesterday is a lawyer. |
| WHOSE | Possession (people/things) | The boy whose phone is missing is looking for it. |
| WHICH | Things or animals | This is the cake which she baked yesterday. |
| THAT | People or things | I like the movie that we watched last night. |
| WHERE | Places | This is the city where I was born. |
| WHEN | Time | Do you remember the day when we met? |
| WHY | Reason | The reason why I left early was my headache. |
| WHAT | Things | I didn't understand what she said. |

# Guided Practice

1. The engineer ____ designed the irrigation system works at our university.
2. The farmer ____ we interviewed explained the new planting method.
3. This is the machine ____ reduces electricity consumption.
4. The student ____ answered the question correctly is in my class.
5. I visited the laboratory ____ the experiments were conducted.
6. Do you know the reason ____ the project was delayed?
7. I still remember the day ____ we presented our research.
8. The researcher ____ papers won an award is very famous.
9. I don’t know ____ caused the error in the system.
10. The company ____ products are eco-friendly is growing quickly.

# Answers

1. who – The engineer who designed the irrigation system works at our university.
2. whom – The farmer whom we interviewed explained the new planting method.
3. which – This is the machine which reduces electricity consumption.
4. who – The student who answered the question correctly is in my class.
5. where – I visited the laboratory where the experiments were conducted.
6. why – Do you know the reason why the project was delayed?
7. when – I still remember the day when we presented our research.
8. whose – The researcher whose papers won an award is very famous.
9. what – I don’t know what caused the error in the system.
10. whose – The company whose products are eco-friendly is growing quickly.

# From Pronouns to Clauses

The system <u>that reduces waste</u> is effective.

👉 The underlined part is a relative clause.

# What Are Relative Clauses?

A relative clause is a group of words that:

✓ Begins with a relative pronoun

✓ Gives extra information about a noun

✓ Helps combine sentences

Relative clauses are also known as Adjective Clauses

# Why Are Relative Clauses Important?

- Improve academic writing
- Provide detailed explanations
- Make communication professional
- Useful in technology, science, and research

# Types of Relative Clauses

1. Defining relative clauses

2. Non-defining relative clauses

- The big car is mine
- These beautiful flowers are for my mother

# Defining Relative Clauses

They give essential information.

Example:

- Students who attend lectures regularly perform better.

- Without this clause → meaning changes.

# Non-defining Relative Clauses

They give extra information.

Example:

- My laptop, which I bought last year, works well.

✓ Use commas

✓ Cannot use “that”

## DEFINING RELATIVE CLAUSES

**NO COMMAS**

INFORMATION that is NECESSARY to distinguish which thing/person we talk about.

*I called my brother who lives in Ontario.*

(=I have more than one brother, and I called the one that lives in Ontario)

**THAT can replace WHO/WHICH**

*That's the mug which/that she likes best.*

*I didn't know the man who/that was there.*

**We can omit WHO/WHICH/THAT when followed by Subject + Verb**

*Do you like the song (which/that) I wrote?*

*That's the man (who/that) I like.*

## NON-DEFINING RELATIVE CLAUSES

**BETWEEN COMMAS**

EXTRA INFORMATION that is NOT NECESSARY to distinguish which thing/ person we talk about.

*My brother, who lives in Ontario, is older.*

(=I have only one brother and I'm just mentioning that he lives in Ontario)

**We cannot use THAT**

*These bikes, which cost a fortune, are made in Japan.* (NOT *that cost a fortune*)

**WHO/WHICH can not be omitted**

*They introduced me to John, who I liked immediately.* (NOT *to John, I liked...*)

test-english.com

# Choose if the following sentences are defining or non defining

1. My friend who lives next door is very kind.

2. The dog, which is very friendly, belongs to my neighbor.

3. I have a brother who plays football.

4. London, which is the capital of England, is very crowded.

5. The boy who won the race is my classmate.

6. My grandmother, who loves baking, made a cake for us.

# Relative Clauses with Prepositions

A relative clause with a preposition is a clause where the relative pronoun is connected to a preposition.

Prepositions can appear:

- Before the relative pronoun → formal style
- At the end of the clause → informal style

Purpose:

✓ To describe relationships between nouns and other elements in a sentence

✓ Common in academic and professional English

| Style | Structure Example | Notes |
| --- | --- | --- |
| Informal | Noun + relative pronoun + rest of clause + preposition at end | “The company that I work for is large.” |
| Formal | Noun + preposition + relative pronoun + rest of clause | “The company for which I work is large.” |

| Informal (Preposition at End) | Formal (Preposition Before Relative Pronoun) |
| --- | --- |
| The project that I am working on is exciting. | The project on which I am working is exciting. |
| The student that we spoke to is from another university. | The student to whom we spoke is from another university. |
| The software that the team relies on is updated regularly. | The software on which the team relies is updated regularly. |
| The company that she applied to is very famous. | The company to which she applied is very famous. |
| The method that the research is based on is effective. | The method on which the research is based is effective. |

https://youtu.be/j25CFx-4g0I?si=ePMqbPqfPJJtNhvz

# Group Activity

A New Technology That Can Improve Daily Life

# THANK YOU